

Glossary

"The future will be green, or not at all. This truth lies at the heart of humankind's most pressing challenge: to learn to live in harmony with the Earth on a genuinely sustainable basis".
Sir Jonathon Porritt

Agenda 21: A comprehensive plan of action to be taken globally, nationally and locally by organizations of the United Nations System, Governments, and Major Groups in every area in which human impacts on the environment.

Amassed: To accumulate or assemble a large quantity of

Biodiversity: The existence of a wide variety of species of plants, animals, and microorganisms in a natural community or habitat. The maintenance of biodiversity is important for the stability of ecosystems.

Brundtland Report: Report of the World Commission on Environment and Development weaves together social, economic, cultural and environmental issues and global solutions.

Consumer society: A society in which the consumption of goods and services is an important social and economic activity

Consumption: Act or process of consuming; waste; decay; destruction. Using up of anything as food, heat, or time.

Communal: Of, belonging to, or shared by the people of a community; public.

Demand-induced scarcity: A situation that arises when the rate of population increase exceeds the growth of essential resources.

Economic Imperialism: The taking over of a country's economy by another country or a corporation.

Ecosystem: The interacting system of a biological community and its non-living environmental surroundings.

Emission: Pollution discharged into the atmosphere from smokestacks, other vents, and surface areas of commercial or industrial facilities; from residential chimneys; and from motor vehicle, locomotive, or aircraft exhausts.

Energy Efficiency: The ratio of the useful output of services from an article of industrial equipment to the energy use by such an article; for example, vehicle miles traveled per gallon of fuel (mpg).

Environmental Carrying Capacity: the maximum number of animals of one or more species that can be supported by a particular habitat or area

Ethnic cleansing: The mass expulsion or extermination of people from opposing cultural, national, or religious groups within a certain area.

Evapotranspiration: The release of water vapour from the earth and surface by the evaporation of surface water and the transpiration of plants.

Exports: To send or transport abroad merchandise, especially for sale or trade.

Free-enterprise system: An economic system, based on laissez-faire economics.

GDP: (Gross domestic product) the total value of goods produced and services provided within a country in one year.

Growth pole theory: An economic development theory that combines the advantage of agglomeration and dispersion. The strategy involves developing new industry in an urban location (or growth pole) in the hope that prosperity will spread to the surrounding area.

Imports: To bring or carry in from an outside source, especially to bring in (goods or materials) from a foreign country for trade or sale.

Indigenous: Originating and living or occurring naturally in an area or environment

Interdependence: when two variables etc. are mutually dependent on one another

Kyoto Protocol: This document sets goals for greenhouse gas emission reduction and establishes emissions trading in developed countries and the clean development mechanism for developing countries.

Marasmus: A nutritional disease characterized by a wasting away of the body and caused by a direct deficient in calories and protein; especially common in bottle-fed babies in the developing world.

Microclimatology: The study of climate conditions for a particular region that may be an anomaly in the larger region in which it is located; e.g., a location in a city may be warmer and less windy than elsewhere because it has southern exposure and is protected by buildings.

Non-governmental organization: (NGO's). Religious groups, service agencies, and other non-profit organizations that provide aid; e.g., the Red Cross

Per Capita: Per unit of population; per person: ex. In that year, Canadians earned \$20,000 per capita

Renewable energy: Energy obtained from sources that are essentially inexhaustible, unlike, for example, the fossil fuels, of which there is a finite supply. Renewable sources of energy include wood, waste, geothermal, wind, photovoltaic, and solar thermal energy

Renewable resource: A naturally occurring resource from the Earth that can replenish itself or grow back again, such as sun, water, trees, and animals.

Structural-adjustment policies: A system of austerity programs imposed by development agencies on a developing country to allow it to reduce its foreign debt. The resultant spending cuts in social programs often cause hardship for citizens.

Structural scarcity: The situation that arises when a government is unable to distribute essential needs to the people.

Sustainability: Adoption of energy and environmental policies which would not threaten the world environment, yet at the same time allow economic growth

Trade balance: The state of a country's trading positions; essentially, the balance of the value of exports and imports.

Ubiquitous resources: Resources that are always present such as soil, air, and water.

Sources : www.Dictionary.com, http://oaspub.epa.gov/trs/trs_proc_qry.alphabet?p_term_nm=SR
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